

Android-x86 4.4 R1 Linux distro available for download and testing

The team behind Android-x86 recently launched version 4.4 R1 of the port of the Android OS designed specifically for the x86 platform. Android-x86 4.4 KitKat is now available for download and testing on the Linux platform for your PC. Android is actually based on a modified Linux kernel, with many believing it to be a stand alone Linux distribution in its own right. With that said, developers have managed to tweak Android to make it port to the PC for the x86 platforms; that's what Android-x86 is really all about.

Linux Mint Debian edition to switch from snapshot cycle to Debian stable package base



The team behind Linux Mint has decided to let go of the current snapshot cycle in the Debian edition for the Linux distribution and instead switch over to a Debian stable package base. The current Linux Mint editions are based on Ubuntu and the team is most likely to stick to that for at least a couple of years. The team recently launched the latest iteration of Linux Mint, a.k.a. 'Qiana'. Both the Cinnamon and Mate versions are now available for download with the KDE and XFCE versions expected to come out soon. Meanwhile, it has been announced that the next three Linux Mint releases would also, in all probability, be based on Ubuntu 14.04 LTS.

as cloud-hosting systems. However, with SDN support added, Oracle is aiming to change all this. Oracle plans to directly take on network equipment makers like Cisco, Hewlett-Packard and Brocade with the introduction of Solaris 11.2. Enterprises using Solaris can now simply purchase a handful of Solaris boxes and run their mission-critical clouds. In addition, they can also use bits of OpenStack without acquiring additional hardware.

Canonical launches Ubuntu 12.04.5 LTS

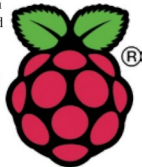
Marking its fifth point release, Canonical has announced that Ubuntu 12.04.5 LTS is available for download and installation. Ubuntu 12.04 LTS was first released back in April 2012. Canonical will continue supporting the LTS until 2017 with regular updates from time to time. Also, this is the first major release for Canonical since the debut of Ubuntu 14.04 LTS earlier this year. The most notable improvement in the new release is the inclusion of an updated kernel (3.13) and X.org stack. Both of these have been traded from Ubuntu 14.04 LTS. The new release is out now for desktop, server, cloud and core products, as well as other flavours of Ubuntu with long-term support. In addition, the new release also comes with 'security updates and corrections for other high-impact bugs, with a focus on maintaining stability and compatibility with Ubuntu 12.04 LTS.' Meanwhile, Kubuntu 12.04.5 LTS, Edubuntu 12.04.5 LTS and Ubuntu Studio 12.04.5 LTS are also available for download and install.



Storm Energy's SunSniffer charmed by Raspberry Pi!

The humble Raspberry Pi single board computer is indeed going places, receiving critical acclaim for, well, being downright awesome. The latest to be smitten by it is the German company, Storm Energy, which builds products like SunSniffer, a solar plant monitoring system. The SunSniffer system is designed to monitor photovoltaic (PV) solar power installations of varied sizes. The company has now upgraded the system to a Linux-based platform running on a Raspberry Pi. In addition to this, the latest SunSniffer version also comes with a custom expansion board and customised Linux OS. The SunSniffer is IP65-rated, and the new Connection Box's custom Raspberry Pi expansion board comes with five RS-485 ports and eight analogue/digital I/O interfaces to help simultaneously monitor a wide variety of solar inverters (Refusol, Huawei and Kostal, among others). In short, the new system can remotely control solar inverters via a radio ripple control receiver, as against earlier versions where users could only monitor their data.

The Raspberry Pi-laden SunSniffer also offers SSL-encryption and optional integrated anti-theft protection.



Italian city of Turin switching to open source technology

In a recent development, the Italian city of Turin is considering ditching all Microsoft products in favour of open source alternatives. The move is directly aimed at cutting government costs, while not compromising on functionality. If at all Turin gets rid of all proprietary software, it will go on to become one of the first Italian 'open source cities' and save itself at least a whopping six million Euros. A report suggests that as many as 8,300 computers of the local administration in Turin will soon have Ubuntu under the hood and will be shipped with the Mozilla Firefox